

Coalition and UN CRPD Addendum

UN Concluding Observations · Municipal Coalition · Budget Cost Doubling

A documented record of the international, municipal, and budgetary evidence now formally on the table — confirming that opposition to Alberta's ADAP transition is not a community grievance but a coalition position grounded in UN findings, elected municipal motions, and the province's own budget figures.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — April 2026 Report Series | Addendum, April 6, 2026

The UN Committee instructed Canada in March 2025 to condition fiscal transfers on CRPD compliance. Bill 12 passed nine months later. The ADAP transition is the documented consequence of inaction on that instruction. Multiple Alberta municipalities are now formally on record opposing it — and the province's own budget shows it costs \$41.6 million more to administer than the existing system.

SECTION 1: UN CRPD CONCLUDING OBSERVATIONS — MARCH 26, 2025

On March 26, 2025 — nine months before Bill 12 passed — the United Nations Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities released its Concluding Observations on Canada's implementation of the CRPD. The review involved 53 disability organizations, 14 of which travelled to Geneva to present in person. The UN Committee's recommendations are directly relevant to Alberta's ADAP transition.

The UN Committee's Recommendation on Provincial Compliance

"Canada should establish legally defined mechanisms ensuring compliance with the CRPD by all provinces and territories, and condition fiscal transfers from the Federal level to provinces and territories on their adherence to the CRPD." — UN Committee on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, Concluding Observations on Canada, March 26, 2025

This is not a new advocacy position. The UN Committee recommended it to Canada fourteen months ago. Alberta's Bill 12 passed in December 2025 — nine months after this recommendation was made. Canada has had the UN's instruction to condition fiscal transfers on CRPD compliance since March 2025. It has not acted on it. Alberta's Bill 12 is the direct and documented consequence of that inaction.

The campaign's federal submission to HUMA (April 2026) calls on the federal government to condition disability transfer payments on non-clawback compliance. This is now doubly grounded: in Canada's own legislative framework and in the UN's formal published recommendation to Canada.

Key CRPD Articles Engaged by Alberta's ADAP Transition

CRPD ARTICLE	CONFIRMED ENGAGEMENT
Article 12 — Equal Recognition Before the Law	79,290 formal findings of permanent disability reversed without new evidence, individual process, or explanation. Canada's own ratification commits it to protecting legal capacity for persons with disabilities. Bill 12 reverses that protection.
Article 13 — Access to Justice	Bill 12 removed the independent Citizens Appeal Panel. The Medical Review Panel's decisions are final. Canada ratified CRPD Article 13 — access to justice for persons with disabilities. Alberta has legislated it away.
Article 19 — Independent Living	Stacked losses — CDB clawback (\$200/month), community housing rent increase (\$221/month), ADAP benefit reduction (\$200/month from January 2028) — total \$621/month. Independent living is not structurally possible at \$1,319/month before any expense.
Article 28 — Adequate Standard of Living	Canada committed under Article 28 to ensure an adequate standard of living for persons with disabilities. AISH already does not cover rent in Alberta. ADAP makes it worse. The UN Committee made this finding explicit in March 2025.

SECTION 2: THE MUNICIPAL COALITION — DOCUMENTED AS OF APRIL 6, 2026

Multiple Alberta municipalities have formally entered this fight. Each has passed or introduced a motion calling on the Government of Alberta to pause the ADAP transition and conduct meaningful consultation.

This is not community advocacy. This is elected municipal governments formally placing themselves on record in opposition to a provincial policy — and citing the downloading of costs onto their own property tax base as a direct municipal concern.

MUNICIPALITY	ACTION TAKEN — STATUS AND KEY DETAILS
City of Edmonton — Mayor Andrew Knack	Motion passed unanimously. Mayor Knack sent a formal letter to Minister Nixon warning of “ <i>significant fear and anxiety within the community regarding the potential social and economic impacts.</i> ” Three asks: pause the transition, continue consultation with persons with disabilities and community partners, publicly report on projected social and economic impacts. <i>Source: Future of Good, March 2026.</i>
City of Lethbridge — Councillor Belinda Crowson	Motion passed unanimously. Council chambers were standing room only. Councillor Crowson stated the community expressed “ <i>a lot of fear</i> ” — distinct from anger. Concerns centred on lack of definition, no right to appeal, and no meaningful consultation. Council chambers erupted in applause following the vote. <i>Source: Lethbridge Herald, February 25, 2026.</i>
City of Red Deer — Councillor Cassandra Curtis	Notice of Motion tabled March 24, 2026. Scheduled to return to council April 15, 2026 for vote. Asks Mayor Cindy Jefferies to formally lobby the province to pause AISH/ADAP changes and undertake meaningful, accessible consultation including medical professionals. <i>Source: RD News Now, March 24, 2026.</i>
Town of Claresholm	Solidarity motion passed. Confirmed by disability advocate Zachary Weeks. <i>Source: Future of Good, March 2026.</i>
City of Camrose	Solidarity motion confirmed. <i>Source: Zachary Weeks, Future of Good, March 2026.</i>
City of Calgary — Mayor Jeromy Farkas	Councillor Keren Tang (Edmonton) confirmed she has spoken with colleagues in Medicine Hat, Calgary and elsewhere. Calgary’s Advisory Committee on Accessibility is active. Mayor Farkas contact: calgary.ca/council/mayor/contact.html — coalition outreach recommended. <i>Source: Future of Good, March 2026.</i>
City of Medicine Hat	Discussions confirmed. <i>Source: Councillor Tang, Future of Good, March 2026.</i>

Why Municipalities Are Involved — The Downloading Argument

“While municipalities can provide some support to low-income households, social assistance programs are generally outside the scope of municipal governments. When programs change, people may turn to the municipality for additional support. Our funding is extremely constrained through property taxes, and typically income support is not something in our realm. So we’re very concerned about the downloading effect of this policy change onto municipalities.” — Councillor Keren Tang, City of Edmonton, March 2026

This is the municipal argument in its clearest form: the province is cutting income support and the resulting homelessness, crisis services, and emergency healthcare will land on city budgets funded by property taxes. This is not a welfare argument. It is a fiscal transfer argument. Municipalities are formally documenting that they expect to absorb the downstream costs of the ADAP transition — costs that do not appear in the province’s stated savings calculation.

Coalition Contact Directory — For Direct Outreach

CONTACT	DETAILS
Mayor Andrew Knack — Edmonton	mayor@edmonton.ca — Formal letter to Nixon on record. Receptive.
Councillor Keren Tang — Edmonton Ward Karhiio	Most active municipal voice. Tabled the Edmonton motion. Accessibility Advisory Committee rep.
Mayor Blaine Hyggen — Lethbridge	Motion passed unanimously under his council.
Councillor Belinda Crowson — Lethbridge	Introduced the Lethbridge motion. Direct contact for coalition coordination.
Mayor Jeromy Farkas — Calgary	calgary.ca/council/mayor/contact.html — Coalition outreach priority. City not yet on formal record.
Councillor Cassandra Curtis — Red Deer	Introduced Notice of Motion March 24. Vote scheduled April 15.
Zachary Weeks — Disability Advocate	Vice-Chair, Edmonton Accessibility Advisory Committee. zacharyweeks.ca — Confirmed Camrose and Claresholm solidarity.

SECTION 3: THE GOVERNMENT'S OWN BUDGET CONFIRMS THE TRANSITION COSTS \$41.6 MILLION MORE TO ADMINISTER

The Government of Alberta's own Budget 2026 documents confirm that the cost of program planning and delivery for disability income assistance has nearly doubled as a direct result of the ADAP transition rollout.

BUDGET LINE	AMOUNT
Program planning and delivery — disability income assistance (2025–26)	\$46.8 million
Program planning and delivery — disability income assistance (2026–27)	\$88.4 million
Year-over-year increase	\$41.6 million — an 89% increase
Stated AISH budget cut (2025–26)	\$49 million
Net saving before administrative costs	Approximately \$7 million

Source: Government of Alberta Budget 2026 documents; Medicine Hat News, March 11, 2026.

The government is spending \$41.6 million more to administer the ADAP transition than it spent running AISH. The transition costs nearly as much to implement as the benefit cut is projected to save — before any downstream costs are counted.

This budget figure does not include:

- Downstream costs of transition-induced homelessness absorbed by municipalities.
- Emergency healthcare and crisis intervention costs for recipients destabilized by income reduction.
- Legal costs of human rights complaints and any future litigation.
- The cost of medical assessments the government has committed to covering for the transition.
- The administrative salary costs documented in the Program Eligibility Assessor and AISH Supervisor job postings (Addendum, April 6, 2026).

THE GOVERNMENT'S OWN BUDGET DOCUMENTS SHOW THE TRANSITION COSTS \$41.6 MILLION MORE TO ADMINISTER THAN THE EXISTING SYSTEM. *The "fiscal necessity" framing is contradicted by the government's own numbers.*

This finding belongs in any submission to the Standing Committee on Human Resources, Skills and Social Development, to the Canadian Human Rights Commission, and to the Alberta Ombudsman. The fiscal

justification for a transition that removes independent appeal rights from 79,000 people with permanent disabilities does not survive contact with the government's own budget documents.

Sources: *ARCH Disability Law Centre | Future of Good | Lethbridge Herald | RD News Now | Medicine Hat News | UN OHCHR | Government of Alberta Budget 2026.*

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

St. Albert, Alberta | April 2026

albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com

Find the public group on Facebook: facebook.com/share/g/1CrU5PfHha/